

We completed a review of the Harvest Strategy Policy and Bycatch Policy in 2026.

The Commonwealth Fisheries Bycatch Policy (Bycatch Policy) provides a framework for managing fishing-related impacts to bycatch species in Commonwealth fisheries. This is done through mechanisms that reduce bycatch, improve mitigation measures for protected species and generally minimise impacts of fishing on the marine environment. Australia pursues bycatch management options that are practical, cost effective to apply and support environmental and fisheries legislative requirements.

History of the Bycatch Policy

The bycatch policy provides a framework for managing fishing-related impacts to bycatch species in Commonwealth fisheries.

The first Bycatch Policy was released in 2000 and implemented in collaboration with the commercial fishing industry.

The Bycatch Policy was revised in 2018, drawing upon the outcomes of the [Report on the review of the Commonwealth Policy on Fisheries Bycatch of May 2013](#).

The Bycatch Policy is supported by implementation guidelines which provide detailed practical guidance on the assessment and management of bycatch species across the diverse range of Commonwealth fisheries.

A second review of the Bycatch Policy, including stakeholder consultation, was completed in 2026. The department is now working to revise the Bycatch Policy based on the review's conclusions.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/fisheries/environment/bycatch/review>